

would then report that information to us! I told them to call Dr. Schwenn, that she would know if we had requested the letter, but to my knowledge we had not. I told them that because cancer is a reportable disease, we normally do not ask the public to report to us cases of cancer. I just returned to the hotel and received another call - this one from Channel 8, saying they had heard a report on WGME (must have been the 5:00 news) and heard about this letter and also wondered what our role is in it. With both, I also emphasized that we get a half dozen to a dozen such inquiries every year and that over the past 25-30 years we've been doing this, we've encountered one possible cluster. However, we take all such inquiries seriously, and it takes usually several months to complete our work in answering people's questions (I purposely did not use the word "investigation").

Can you pls give us an update on this situation? Thank you!! Dora

-----Original Message-----

From: Mills, Dora A.

Sent: Tuesday, December 26, 2006 12:40 PM

To: Verrill, Castine

Cc: Schwenn, Molly; Poirier, Barbara; Zukas-Lessard, Chris

Subject: RE: North Deering Cancer Concern

Thank you very much, Castine, for your quick and thorough reply. Please keep me in the loop. Dora

From: Verrill, Castine

Sent: Tue 12/26/2006 10:00 AM

To: 'portej@portlandschools.org'; 'russep@portlandschools.org';
'mcleoj@portlandschools.org'

Cc: Schwenn, Molly; Mills, Dora A.

Subject: North Deering Cancer Concern

Dear All Concerned Parties,

I am writing from the Maine Cancer Registry, a program within the Maine Center for Disease Control and Prevention (formerly the Bureau of Health). Dr. Dora Mills forwarded your letter of concern about cancer in the neighborhood of North Deering. The Maine Cancer Registry takes such concerns seriously and has an established protocol for evaluating these concerns. The first step is to gather information on the 29 cancer cases that have been identified. For each case, we will need to know the following:

1. Name
2. Gender
3. Type of cancer (breast, lung, leukemia, etc.)
4. Year the cancer was diagnosed
5. The person's age when the cancer was diagnosed
6. Where the person was living at the time of diagnosis
7. How long the person had lived at this residence
8. Whether the person is still alive
9. Hospital where the person was diagnosed or treated (if known)

Once this information is received, we will attempt to verify the cases in our database. We will also search for additional cases diagnosed in residents of North Deering. If there are specific environmental concerns, please notify us of these as well. This information will then be reviewed by our Cancer Inquiry Team to determine the appropriate next steps.

The case information above can be shared with me over the phone, fax, or via mail. Please

refrain from sending the information by email, as it is not a secure means for transmitting confidential data.

Thank you for bringing this concern to our attention. Please contact me with any questions.

Sincerely,

Castine Verrill, MS

Epidemiologist

Maine Cancer Registry

Maine CDC

286 Water Street, 4th Floor

11 State House Station

Augusta, ME 04333

Phone: (207) 287-5190

Fax: (207) 287-4631

castine.verrill@maine.gov

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